

» WORLD VIEW OF THE FORTNIGHT



« Professional athletes should be able to compete without dedicating brain space to constant vigilance of having every vulnerable piece of your body on display.

— Former U.S. national 5,000m champion Lauren Fleshman on USA's Paris Olympic kit »



« I didn't miss the discipline and the difficulty of the life I had before. I have been realising that what I most want to look forward to is my next chapter.

— Former Wimbledon and French Open champion Garbine Muguruza announcing her retirement at a news conference »

6.24

Armand Duplantis put down a marker ahead of this year's Paris Olympics as the Swede broke his own pole vault world record with a 6.24 metres effort in the first Diamond League meeting of the 2024 season. Duplantis bettered his previous mark of 6.23 metres set at the Eugene Diamond League finale in September, clearing the bar with ease before leaping up off the sponge mat below and racing off in celebration at his first outdoor event of the

year. It was the eighth time that Duplantis broke the world record, and the 24-year-old was the only man to clear six metres at the Egret Stadium.



3

The top three in Beijing half marathon have been stripped of their medals, organisers said, following an investigation into the finish that saw China's He Jie controversially win. The race's bizarre finish saw He Jie cross the line first after two runners from Kenya and one from Ethiopia seemed to deliberately allow him to win. He Jie, the 2023 Asian Games marathon gold medallist, won by one second after his rivals appeared to slow down towards the finish and waved him out in front.

HANGING HIS BOOTS



Two-time world champion Kento Momota said he is retiring from international badminton aged 29, ending a top-level career that never recovered from a car crash four years ago. Momota, who had already missed out on a place at the Paris Olympics, will play for Japan for the last time at the Thomas Cup in China. The former World No. 1 will only feature in domestic competitions in Japan after that and not on badminton's World Tour. AFP